concealing it in her hair. Having evaded their pursuers, they sailed from the port of Tamralipti to Lanka, where they presented the tooth to King Kittisiri Megha, who built a great temple at his capital Anuradhapura in which the tooth was installed in the year 311 CE.

This was by no means the end of the vicissitudes suffered by Sri Lanka's famous Buddha Tooth,[15] but what concerns us here is that this sacred tooth evidently remained in Dantapuri in Kalinga for several centuries before its removal to Lanka – which raises the question: where was Dantapuri?

One claimant is a small village called Danthavarapuri not far from the coast in the Srikakulam District of northern Odisha. It does indeed have some mud fortifications where excavations by the ASI revealed traces of several ancient wells, possible stupas and various types of early pottery, but not enough to convince that this was the site of the fabled capital of ancient Kalinga.

It was General Cunningham of the ASI who first proposed that Puri was the original site of Dantapuri, and who first suggested that the Jagannath deity may have had its origins in the Buddha's tooth. In examining the Buddhist symbols displayed at Sanchi he noticed that one of the most widespread was the *triratna*, representing the 'three jewels' of Buddhism: the Buddha, his Dharma and the *Sangha*, or Buddhist church (see sketch on page 226). This *triratna*, he observed, was identical in form to the three *daru*s representing Jagannath, Balabhadra and Subhadra at Puri.[16] Furthermore, wrote Cunningham, 'these same rude [i.e. crude] Jagannath figures are used in all the native almanacs of Mathura Benaras as the representative of Buddha in the Budha Avatar of Vishnu.' All this, Cunningham went on, 'shows in the clearest and most unequivocal manner the absolute identity of the holy Brahmanical Jagannath with the ancient Buddhist triad'.